



Armada Kalamunda Group

Meningococcal Post Exposure Prophylaxis Guideline

1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to provide information with regards to the appropriate management of healthcare workers following occupational exposure to meningococcal disease.

Mandatory notification of infectious disease

Meningococcal infection is a notifiable infectious disease; all cases must be reported to the Communicable Disease Control Directorate by completing a notification form [online](#) or printing out the [notification form](#) and faxing it to the WA Department of Health via (08) 9222 0254.

2. Workforce contact management

The process below outlines the steps to take for healthcare workers (HCWs) who have had [unprotected close prolonged contact](#) for >4 hours with the infected patient's nasopharyngeal secretions within seven days preceding the onset of disease:

1. Any HCW who meets the above criteria must attend the Emergency Department for triaging (Kalamunda Hospital staff to follow the Infectious Diseases advice as outlined in the box below).

Infectious disease advice

During hours please contact the NUM and Infection Prevention and Management (IPM) staff for guidance. After hours contact the Nurse Shift Coordinator who will contact the on call Infectious Diseases team for advice.

2. A medication charted prescription for ciprofloxacin 500mg per oral is to be completed for each case. If a staff member has an allergy to ciprofloxacin or is pregnant, please seek advice from the Infectious Disease Physician.

Chemoprophylaxis access

- Medication must be obtained from pharmacy and must not be taken from ward stock or from the Emergency Department stock.
- Pharmacy has a supply box of ciprofloxacin assigned for staff that require prophylaxis for meningococcal disease exposure.
- The supply box can be obtained from Pharmacy staff during office hours or via the Hospital Nurse Manager after hours.

Before referencing this guideline document please ensure that you have the latest version from the [Policy Library](#) information hub page.

3. The medication chart must be signed by the person administering the medication; the chart is to be retained in the staff members healthcare record and a scanned copy of the medication cart is to be forwarded to the Infection Prevention and Management team via email: AHSinfection.ControlNurses@health.wa.gov.au
4. All contacts should be advised of the signs and symptoms of meningococcal disease and the need to seek immediate medical attention should they appear. The [meningococcal disease fact sheet](#) should be provided.

3. Legislative context

The following documents are required to give effect to this policy:

- *Public Health Act 2016 (WA)*
- *Occupational Safety and Health Act 1984 (WA)*
- HDWA [Management of Occupational Exposure to Blood or Body Fluids in Healthcare Settings](#)
- EMHS [Infection Prevention and Management Policy](#)

4. Supporting information

The following documents support the implementation of this policy:

- AKG [Occupational Exposure to Blood and Body Fluids Procedure](#)

5. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

- Standard 3 – Action 3.5 Standard and transmission-based precautions
- Standard 3 – Action 3.6 Clinicians assess infection risks and use transmission-based precautions based on the risk of transmission of infectious agents, and consider:

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6. References

1. Centres for Disease Control and Prevention. (1998). Guidelines for Infection Control in Health Care Personnel. *Infection Control & Hospital Epidemiology*, 19, 407-63.
2. Communicable Diseases Network Australia (2017). CDNA National Guidelines for Public Health Units: Invasive Meningococcal Disease.

7. Glossary

The following definitions are relevant to this policy.

Term	Definition
Close prolonged contact	This includes the following: • mouth-to-mouth resuscitation • intubation/bronchoscopy • close examination of the oropharynx • frequent suctioning

Term	Definition
	prolonged or intensive contact >4 hours without the use of appropriate PPE.

8. Document owner

Director Nursing and Midwifery

Enquiries relating to this guideline may be directed to:

Title: Clinical Nurse Specialist Infection Prevention and Management

Department: Infection Prevention and Management

Email: AHSInfection.ControlNurses@health.wa.gov.au

9. Review

This guideline will be reviewed and evaluated as required to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
V3	12/06/2024	12/06/2027	Scheduled review

10. Authorisation

This guideline has been authorised and issued by the Director Nursing and Midwifery.

Authorised by	Denver Prince – A/Director Nursing and Midwifery
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